

decision-making process regarding your credit is supposed to be made based upon your facts and figures, not your personal information.

Your sex, your race, and your nationality do not matter. How much you have in your bank account does not matter. The credit score is supposed to be an objective tool for the lending industry to be able to compare apples to apples: how this guy pays his bills versus how that guy pays his bills.

Let's take the fictional story of Joe. He is male, single, Muslim, gay, Arab, born in Iran, and wants a personal loan to take his Korean Buddhist boyfriend on vacation. The white, Irish Catholic, married female loan officer has to make her decision based solely on his credit score. She cannot discriminate against Joe, based on his gender, race, religion, nationality, marital status, or sexual orientation. Or the fact that he wore plaid pants and a garish yellow raincoat, and had greasy hair. The credit industry devised the credit report and credit score method in order to make their decisions objectively, and that is all they can use.

Decision Making

The credit score is more important than we sometimes realize. Even if you are one of the rare individuals who does not carry a credit card, have a home mortgage loan, a car loan, a student loan, or a personal loan, the credit report and credit score still have an impact on you. I have never met anybody who falls into that category, but I am sure that there are some of you out there. Be advised. Your insurance company looks at your credit score to determine what kind of policy to give you. Your employer can even look at your credit report and credit score when trying to decide whether to hire or promote you. The credit score permeates into many corners of our lives.

Let's look at Jane, who is divorced with three kids. She applied for a cashier job at the local ice cream shop. She's half Jewish, half Christian, half white, half black. She is overweight, over forty, and has a limp. On the 4th of July, she marched in a parade with a banner that stated "Down With America." Okay, maybe my tale is a little extreme, but she is just an example I created to make my point.